

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 33

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

In the second chapter of his letter, James writes about faith. To give us a better understanding of what James is teaching us, Nancy has introduced other accurate and valid translations of the Greek word for faith, including *trust*, *believe*, and *a set of beliefs*.

Let's listen now to Nancy's paraphrase of **James 2:10–23**.

¹⁰If you try to use the law of your Idol's system and then fail in one area of your law, you will condemn everything about yourself. ¹¹The same Lawgiver who says, "Do not be sexually untrustworthy," also says, "Do not be murderous." In other words, if you choose to live by law and be chaste, but are still murderous, you make yourself fail the whole law. ¹²Instead, speak and also act like people who are brought to court by the law of freedom rather than like a slave of the Idol. ¹³The result of a trial according to the Idol's law will be inexorable for those who are inexorable. They cannot help but punish themselves through self-hate. Mercy, however, exults and is self-confident in trials. Mismanaged self-hate throws us back into slavery, but having mercy on ourselves and others is the new way to handle mistakes. Mercy is real self-confidence in action.

¹⁴How does it benefit you or anyone if someone says that they believe but do not act on what they believe? Their belief will not rescue or help them, or anyone else. ¹⁵And that lack of congruence will come out in their choices when they encounter other members in the community who are in need. ¹⁶One of you may say to the one in need, "Go away from me in peace with my blessing of warmth and food." Their need is stirring up conflicts in you and since you won't deal with your inner conflict about showing mercy to yourself, you refuse to deal with any other conflict about mercy. ¹⁷In this way, relying on a set of beliefs without taking action destroys your faith's vitality. ¹⁸Look at it this way. You say that you trust God, or have a set of beliefs that you trust, but I take action. Show me your trust apart from action, and I will show you my trust by my action. Which is more real? ¹⁹You say that you believe that God is undivided in His person and in His activities, and that is admirable. Even demons believe that. But unlike you who separate faith from action, demons are congruently afraid of God. ²⁰You vain and pretentious people, are you willing to recognize that your faith separated from your action is not doing its job? It is not preparing your soil for seeds of orientation. ²¹Abraham, who was our first example of a person

living in a relationship with God based on faith, was oriented through his action—taking Isaac, his son, up to the place of sacrifice, just like you are learning to sacrifice your dreams of an idealized glory. ²²You can see that his faith is co-active with his action, and through his action his faith reached its fulfillment. That fulfillment was orientation to God. Abraham's gift in karis relationship to God was his effort, not his set of beliefs. ²³And what is written was fulfilled: "Abraham was trustworthy with God, responding to God with his karis gift, and this act—this offering—was credited to him as orientation, and he was called the beloved friend of God."

Take a deep breath.

Let's look at a few points from this passage:

1. The law cannot rescue you

You cannot rescue the True Self by imposing legal systems on your life. It is impossible to fulfill all the requirements of a legal system, and if you try, you will always be in danger of self-condemnation.

2. Freedom is what kidnapped slaves are seeking

Slaves have no power over their own lives, and yet they can envision a life of freedom. In Christ, we are citizens living under the law of liberty, and we have the freedom, the resources, and, also, the responsibility to change our lives.

3. Mercy is self-confidence in action

Mercy is the opposite of self-hate. Mercy is the law of Jesus in the court of freedom. Free people go about their own business without the fear of failure or the fear of making mistakes. They get mercy because they give mercy.

4. Mercy toward others

The unseen mercy that we show to ourselves is manifested in the material world by the mercy we show to others. Mercy is an active, effortful self-extension that shows God we mean business about His mission, His priorities, and our relationship with Him. Showing mercy is difficult. It costs us something. That's why mercy is a karis gift.

5. God is united in effort and principle

We are called to be imitators of God, doing what we know to be good, right, and fair. James reminds us that what God says, He does. He doesn't compartmentalize, believing one thing and yet doing something else.

6. Abraham gave the karis gift of obedience

In obedient response to God's request, Abraham relinquished what he loved most—his son, who was his hope for the fulfillment of his search for glory. Through his choices, not his ideas, Abraham became God's beloved friend.

Our prayer might go something like this:

God of Abraham, help me become Your trustworthy friend. (Repeat)

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are so grateful for this time together. Hold us in the power of trustworthiness as You continue to guide us to our real glory. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and design, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.